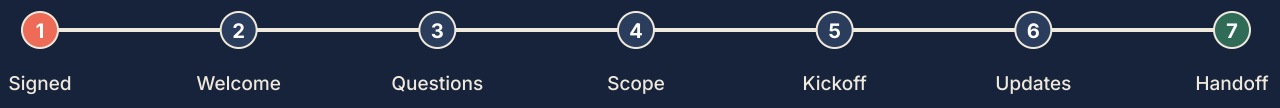
HUSTLE STUDIO · FREELANCER TOOLS

Signed to Kickoff

Freelance Client Onboarding Kit · Guide

From "yes" to a smooth first week, the same way for every client.

HTML generator | Letter + A4 guide | Templates | 8 emails | XLSX checklist



Guidance, not legal advice.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Start Here

Onboarding is everything between a client's "yes" and the first week of real work: the welcome, the questions, the scope, the kickoff call, the updates and, at the end, the handoff. This kit gives you a document or an email for each of those moments, and a checklist so none of them slips.

Your first 15 minutes

1. Open **client-onboarding-kit.html** in your browser. Click **Load example** to see a finished set for Maya, a brand designer.
2. Click **Reset**. Fill in section **A · You** once and click **Save**. Your details stay in this browser.
3. Fill in section **B · Client & project** for your next client and pick your field for the questionnaire.
4. Open each document tab, choose Letter or A4, and click **Print / Save as PDF**. Attach the PDFs to Email 1.
5. Add the client to **client-onboarding-checklist.xlsx** and mark each step Done as you go.

What's in the kit (7 files)

File	What it is
client-onboarding-kit.html	The generator: 5 documents and 8 emails from one form. Works offline.
onboarding-guide-letter.pdf / -a4.pdf	This guide, in US Letter and A4 (same pages).
onboarding-templates.md	The 5 documents as text with [Placeholders], plus all 70 questions.
onboarding-emails.txt	The 8 emails as text, each with a Subject line.
client-onboarding-checklist.xlsx	20 steps × 8 clients with completion %, plus a 20-row client list.
README.txt	Which file to open first, Google Sheets import, support.

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How the pieces fit together

The **generator** is where you work day to day: one form, five documents, eight emails, all with the same names, dates and amounts. The **text templates** (.md and .txt) hold the same wording with [Placeholders], for when you want to rewrite a paragraph in your own voice or keep a document in Google Docs or Notion. The **checklist** tracks which step each client is on. This **guide** explains why each step exists and what to write in each field.

Using it with your own paperwork

Keep your own contract or agreement and your own invoices. The kit starts the moment those are sent, and covers the client-facing communication around them. The figures you type (fee, deposit %, payment terms) should match your invoice exactly; the generator then repeats them consistently in every document and email.

Where your details are stored

Only in your own browser. Click **Save** and the generator remembers what you typed on this computer. Nothing is uploaded anywhere. If you clear your browser data or open the file in a different browser, it starts empty, so keep the PDFs you send in each client's folder.

> ⓘ **Not legal advice.** This kit helps you communicate clearly. It is not a legal contract and does not replace your own agreement or advice from a lawyer where you work.

CHAPTER 01

The 7-Step Onboarding Flow

The same seven steps for every client, in the same order.

1 Signed — 2 Welcome — 3 Questions — 4 Scope — 5 Kickoff — 6 Updates — 7 Handoff

When onboarding is improvised, small things fall through: the deposit invoice goes out late, the logo files arrive in week three, nobody agreed what "a revision" means. A fixed flow removes those gaps. Each step below has one job and one file or email from this kit.

1

SIGNED · DAY 0

The client says yes. Send your contract or agreement and the deposit invoice. These come from your own paperwork; this kit starts right after.

2

WELCOME · DAY 0

Email 1 + Welcome Guide. Timeline, how to reach you, payment plan and the next 3 steps, in one PDF.

3

QUESTIONS · DAYS 0–3

Discovery Questionnaire (22 questions for the client's field). If it isn't back in 2–3 working days, send Email 2.

4

SCOPE · BEFORE KICKOFF

Scope & Revisions Confirmation. What's included, what isn't, revision rounds and how changes work, signed by both of you.

5

KICKOFF · BEFORE THE START DATE

Email 3 + Kickoff Call Agenda for a 30-minute call. Within 24 hours, send the recap (Email 4).

6

UPDATES · EVERY WEEK

Email 5 on the same day each week. **Email 6** whenever a milestone is ready for approval.

7

HANDOFF · DELIVERY DAY + 1–2 WEEKS

Email 7 + Project Handoff & Feedback sheet with the final files. One to two weeks later, **Email 8** asks for feedback.

The day-0 pack

Steps 2, 3 and 4 can leave together. On the day the client signs, send Email 1 with three PDFs attached: the Welcome Guide, the Discovery Questionnaire and the Scope & Revisions Confirmation. The client gets one tidy email instead of three scattered ones, and you start the clock on the questionnaire and the signature at the same time.

When	You send	Kit file
Day 0	Email 1 + 3 PDFs	Generator: Welcome, Questionnaire, Scope tabs
Day 2–3	Email 2 if the questionnaire isn't back	Email 2
Answers + signature in	Email 3 with the agenda	Kickoff Call Agenda tab
Within 24 h of the call	Email 4 recap	Email 4
Weekly / per milestone	Email 5 / Email 6	Email 5, Email 6
Delivery	Email 7 + handoff sheet + balance invoice	Handoff tab, Email 7
1–2 weeks later	Email 8 feedback request	Email 8

When the client is in a hurry

Some projects start in days, not weeks. Keep every step but shrink them: send the day-0 pack, book the kickoff call for the next working day, and go through the questionnaire together on the call instead of waiting for written answers. Don't skip the scope confirmation. A rushed start is exactly when "I thought that was included" happens.

When you already have a contract

Keep it. The Scope & Revisions Confirmation is a plain-English summary for the client, written so they actually read it. If your contract and the summary ever disagree, your contract decides, so check both say the same thing before you send them.

Track it, so nothing slips

Open **client-onboarding-checklist.xlsx**. The Checklist tab lists 20 steps for up to 8 clients; pick Done, Not yet or N/A in each cell. The bottom row shows each client's completion as Done ÷ (20 − N/A), and turns green at 100%. The Clients tab keeps one row per client with the stage, whether the deposit is paid and the days since signing.

CHAPTER 02

The Welcome Guide

One page that answers the client's first ten questions.

1 Signed · 2 **Welcome** · 3 Questions · 4 Scope · 5 Kickoff · 6 Updates · 7 Handoff

Right after signing, a new client wants to know: what happens now, when, how do I reach you, and what do I owe? The Welcome Guide answers all of it on one or two pages, with your business name at the top.

What's in it, and what to type

Section	Comes from these fields
Welcome + summary	Client contact, project name, start date, delivery date, project fee
01 Timeline	Up to 6 milestones, each with a name and a date
02 How to reach me	Preferred channel, email, working hours, time zone, reply-within hours
03 Payments	Fee and deposit %: the deposit and the balance are calculated for you
04 Next 3 steps	Pay the deposit, return the questionnaire, sign the scope
05 Quick answers	6 FAQ answers using your revision rounds, hourly rate and delivery date

WORKED EXAMPLE · MAYA

`2,700 × 50% = 1,350 · balance 2,700 - 1,350 = 1,350`

Deposit $1,350 · Balance $1,350

Amounts are rounded to whole numbers with a thousands separator. The balance is always the fee minus the deposit, so the two add up to the fee exactly.

Milestones: how many, and how to name them

Use 3 to 6. Each one should be something the client can see or approve, named the way they'd describe it: "Logo concepts", not "Phase 2". Put the final delivery as the last milestone, with the same date as the delivery date, so the timeline and the summary strip agree.

A reply time you can keep

The guide promises a reply "within `[Reply Hours]` hours on working days". Choose a number you can hit in your busiest week, not your quietest. 24 or 48 hours both work, as long as you say it up front. A promise you keep builds more trust than a fast one you miss.

Choosing the deposit

Pick a deposit you're comfortable starting work on, such as 30% or 50%, and use the same number on your invoice. The Welcome Guide, the Scope confirmation and Email 1 all use the figure you type, so they can't disagree with each other.

The 6 quick answers

The FAQ covers revisions, late feedback, who gives feedback, when files arrive, adding work and pausing. If your policy differs (for example, files on delivery regardless of payment), edit that answer in **onboarding-templates.md** and send the edited version instead.

Sending it

1. Open the Welcome Guide tab, choose Letter or A4.
2. Click **Print / Save as PDF** and pick "Save as PDF". Turn off the browser's "Headers and footers" option for a clean page.
3. Name the file so the client can find it later, e.g. `Welcome-Guide-Northfield-Coffee.pdf`.
4. Attach it to Email 1, with the questionnaire and scope confirmation.

CHECK BEFORE SENDING

Scan for any `[Placeholder]` in square brackets. Each one is a field you left empty. Fill it in, or delete that line in the text template.

CHAPTER 03

Discovery Questions

70 questions: 10 for everyone, 12 for each of 5 fields.

The generator's questionnaire sends the 10 general questions plus the 12 for the field you pick: 22 in all, about 20 minutes for the client. Below is the full bank, word for word as in the generator, so you can borrow a question from another field when a project crosses over (a web designer may want D1–D3; a copywriter on a launch may want M6).

HOW TO USE THE ANSWERS

Read them the day they arrive. Mark anything vague or missing, and bring those points to the kickoff call ("Questionnaire follow-ups", 6 minutes). Don't add more than 2–3 questions of your own: a long form comes back late.

GENERAL · 10

- **G1** In one or two sentences, what does your business do, and for whom?
- **G2** What is the main goal of this project? What should be different when it's finished?
- **G3** How will you know the project was a success? Name one or two signs you'll look for.
- **G4** Who are your ideal customers or readers? Describe them as specifically as you can.
- **G5** Who are your main competitors or alternatives, and what do you like or dislike about them?
- **G6** Who will give feedback and approve the work? Who has the final say?
- **G7** Are there any fixed dates, launches or events this project must be ready for?
- **G8** What have you already tried or made for this, and what did or didn't work?
- **G9** What files, logins or materials will you share with me, and by when?
- **G10** Is there anything that worries you about this project, or anything you'd like me to avoid?

DESIGN · 12

D1 Which three words should people use to describe your brand after seeing the new design?

D2 Which three words should they never use?

D3 Share 2–3 brands or designs you admire (in any industry). What do you like about each?

D4 Is there anything in your current visual identity you want to keep (colours, symbol, typeface)?

D5 Are there colours you love, or colours you want to avoid? Why?

D6 Where will the design be used most: website, social media, packaging, print, signage, or somewhere else?

D7 Do you have existing brand guidelines, logo files or fonts? Please list what you can send.

D8 Do you prefer a wordmark, a symbol, or both together? Or would you like my recommendation?

D9 Which sizes and formats do you need for the final files (for example print, web, social profiles)?

D10 Are there legal names, taglines or trademarks that must appear exactly as written?

D11 Who will use the final files day to day, and which software do they use?

D12 Is there any imagery, style or symbol that would be inappropriate for your audience or culture?

WEB DEVELOPMENT · 12

W1 What is the website's main job: sell, generate leads, inform, or something else?

W2 Which platform are you on now, or want to use (for example WordPress, Shopify, Webflow, custom code)?

W3 Who owns the domain and hosting, and can you invite me as a user?

W4 Which accounts will I need (CMS, hosting, DNS, payments, analytics, email)? Please share access securely, not in a plain email.

W5 Which pages or features must be ready at launch, and which can wait for a later phase?

W6 Who will write and supply the text, images and product data, and by when?

W7 Which third-party tools must the site connect to (payments, booking, newsletter, CRM)?

W8 Which browsers and devices matter most to your customers?

W9 Are there accessibility, privacy or legal requirements (cookie notice, terms, accessibility standards)?

W10 Who will update the site after launch, and what do they need to do without a developer?

W11 Do you have analytics or traffic data from the current site that I can look at?

W12 How should the launch happen: on a set date, as a quiet launch, or after a full backup of the old site?

WRITING & COPY · 12

C1 What is the piece (or set of pieces) for, and what should the reader do after reading it?

C2 Who is the reader? What do they already know, and what do they doubt?

C3 Describe the tone you want in three words. Is there a tone you want to avoid?

C4 Share 2–3 pieces of writing you like (yours or someone else's). What works in each?

C5 Are there words, phrases or claims you always use, or never use?

C6 Which key facts, numbers or proof points must I include? Where can I check them?

C7 Who are your competitors, and how should your message sound different from theirs?

C8 Do you follow a style guide (US or UK spelling, AP, Chicago, a house style)?

C9 Who will review drafts, and will their comments arrive together in one document?

C10 Are there SEO keywords, word counts or formats I need to hit?

C11 Will I interview anyone (you, your team, your customers)? Who, and how do I reach them?

C12 Where will the copy be published, and who will format and upload it?

MARKETING & SOCIAL · 12

M1 Which goal matters most for the next 90 days: awareness, leads, sales, or community?

M2 Which channels are you active on now, and which ones should we focus on?

M3 What results have you had so far on each channel? Please share any numbers you track.

M4 Who is your ideal follower or customer, and where do they spend time online?

M5 Which competitors or accounts do you watch, and what do you think they do well?

M6 What are your key offers, launches or promotions in the next 3 months?

M7 What content do you already have (photos, videos, blog posts, customer quotes you have permission to use)?

M8 Who approves posts or campaigns before they go live, and how much notice do they need?

M9 What is your monthly budget for paid ads, if any, and who owns the ad account?

M10 Which topics, words or images are off-limits for your brand?

M11 Which accounts will I need access to, and at what permission level?

M12 How do you want results reported to you, and how often?

CONSULTING · 12

K1 What is the specific problem or decision you want help with?

K2 What would a good outcome look like 3 months after we finish?

K3 What have you already tried to solve it, and what happened?

K4 Who are the key people involved, and who makes the final decision?

K5 Which data, reports or documents can you share before we start?

K6 What constraints should I know about (budget, people, time, policies)?

K7 Which parts of the business are off-limits or sensitive in this project?

K8 How involved do you want to be: regular working sessions, or a recommendation at the end?

K9 What format do you want the final output in (report, presentation, workshop, plan)?

K10 How do you prefer to decide: with data, with options to compare, or with one clear recommendation?

K11 Are there people who might resist the changes, and how should we involve them?

K12 How will you measure whether my recommendations worked?

Four answers to raise on the kickoff call

If the answer is...	Ask on the call
No one named in G6 (who approves)	"Who signs off on each milestone? I'll send drafts to that person."
"ASAP" in G7 (fixed dates)	"Is there a date something goes live? If not, the delivery date in the Welcome Guide stands."
"Later" in G9 (files and logins)	"The timeline starts when I have these. Can we set a date for each?"
A one-word goal in G2 or G3	"If this works, what would you notice in three months?"

Keeping logins safe

W4 and M11 ask for account access. Ask clients to invite you as a user, or to use a password manager's sharing feature, rather than emailing passwords. Remove your access at handoff and say so in Email 7.

CHAPTER 04

Scope & Revisions

Write down what's out, not only what's in.

1 Signed · 2 Welcome · 3 Questions · 4 **Scope** · 5 Kickoff · 6 Updates · 7 Handoff

A scope argument starts with something nobody wrote down. The Scope & Revisions Confirmation puts a ✓ Included list next to a ✕ Not included list, so the client sees both before work starts.

Writing deliverables you can count

Each line should be something you can hand over and the client can tick off on the handoff sheet. Add a number or a format: "12-page brand guidelines (PDF)", not "brand guidelines"; "5 product pages in Shopify", not "store setup".

Writing "Not included"

List the things a client could reasonably assume come with the project. You're not refusing them; the confirmation says they can be quoted separately. Examples by field:

Field	Often assumed, worth listing as not included
Design	Website design, copywriting or tagline, photography, printing
Web Development	Content writing, ongoing maintenance, hosting fees, SEO campaigns
Writing & Copy	Design and layout, publishing or uploading, translations, extra drafts
Marketing & Social	Ad spend, community replies outside agreed hours, video production
Consulting	Carrying out the recommendations, hiring, legal or tax advice

Revision rounds: define the word "round"

The confirmation says a round means **one set of combined notes**. That one sentence matters: five emails from three people over a week are one round only if they arrive together. Ask for a single document or email per round, from the person who approves the work.

Type the number of included rounds and your hourly rate for extra work once in the generator. Both appear in the Welcome Guide FAQ, the Scope confirmation and Email 6, so the client sees the same numbers three times.

The 4-step change process

Step	What happens
1 · You ask	The client emails the change, so it's in writing.
2 · I estimate	You reply with cost and new dates within your reply time.
3 · You approve	The client replies "approved". Nothing starts before that.
4 · I start	The change is billed at your hourly rate, as agreed.

When a request lands outside the scope, point to the confirmation rather than arguing: "That's on the Not included list, so I'll send a quick estimate." For a full set of replies to scope creep and pushback on price, see the *Freelance Pricing & Quote Kit*.

Getting it signed

Ask for the signed confirmation before the kickoff call, and bring it up in the call's scope walk-through (5 minutes). A typed name and date in a reply email is fine if printing and signing is a hassle for the client.

ⓘ The Scope & Revisions Confirmation is a project summary, **not a legal contract**, and this guide is not legal advice. Keep your own agreement for payment terms, ownership and liability.

CHAPTER 05

The Kickoff Call

30 minutes, 7 segments, one recap email.

1 Signed · 2 Welcome · 3 Questions · 4 Scope · **5 Kickoff** · 6 Updates · 7 Handoff

The kickoff call turns the paperwork into a shared plan. Keep it to 30 minutes and use the same agenda every time: the client sees you run a tight process from the first meeting.

Time	Segment	What to say or ask	Min
0:00–0:03	**Welcome and introductions**	"Who's on the call, and who approves the work?"	3
0:03–0:08	**Goals and what success looks like**	"If this works, what's different in three months?"	5
0:08–0:14	**Questionnaire follow-ups**	The vague or missing answers you marked.	6
0:14–0:19	**Scope walk-through**	Read the Not included list aloud. Confirm rounds.	5
0:19–0:23	**Timeline and milestones**	What you need from them before each date.	4
0:23–0:27	**How we'll communicate**	Channel, reply time, weekly update day, feedback.	4
0:27–0:30	**Next steps and owners**	Who does what before the first milestone.	3
	Total		**30**

3 + 5 + 6 + 5 + 4 + 4 + 3 = 30 minutes.

Before the call

- Client: questionnaire sent back, scope confirmation read.
- You: answers read, follow-up questions listed on the agenda.
- Both: the person who approves the work is invited.
- You: call link and agenda sent with Email 3.

Running it

Share your screen with the agenda open and keep an eye on the clock. When a topic needs more than its slot, park it: "Let's take that offline. I'll put it in the recap with a proposal." The recap is where open points get answered, in writing.

If the call runs over

Stop at 30 minutes anyway, unless the client asks to continue. Ending on time is part of the impression. Book a 15-minute follow-up for anything left.

After the call: the recap (Email 4)

Send it within 24 hours. It repeats the project, dates, first milestone, revision rounds and the Not included list, then two lines you complete: **Decisions we made** and **What I need from you**. It ends with "If anything here doesn't match what you heard, reply by the end of tomorrow." Silence after that is a useful record that you both heard the same thing.

- Any scope change agreed on the call: confirm it in writing before you act on it.
- Confirm the first milestone and its date.
- Set up the shared folder and access.
- Agree the weekly update day and put it in your calendar.

NO CALL POSSIBLE?

Some clients prefer email. Send the agenda as a list of questions instead, and treat their written reply as the kickoff. Still send the recap.

CHAPTER 06

Communication Rules

Say how you'll talk before the first question arrives.

1 Signed · 2 Welcome · 3 Questions · 4 Scope · 5 Kickoff · **6 Updates** · 7 Handoff

A slower reply is easy to accept when the client knows when it will come. Three rules, set in the Welcome Guide and repeated on the kickoff call, cover it.

Rule 1 · One channel

Pick the channel where decisions are made (email keeps a searchable record) and name it in the generator. Quick chats elsewhere are fine, but anything that changes scope, dates or money gets repeated in that channel.

Rule 2 · A reply time and working hours

The Welcome Guide states your working hours, time zone and reply time. Keep to them from day one, including not replying at 11 p.m. "just this once": the client learns your real hours from what you do.

Rule 3 · A weekly update on a fixed day

Email 5 has three lines: **Done this week**, **Next week**, **What I need from you**, plus the next milestone and the delivery date. It takes five minutes and saves the "just checking in" emails from the client.

A filled-in weekly update

> **Subject:** Brand Refresh: weekly update
>
> Hi Sam,
> Here's this week's update on Brand Refresh.
>
> Done this week: moodboard approved; first logo sketches started.
> Next week: three logo concepts, ready for review on Nov 3, 2026.
> What I need from you: the old logo files, if you can find them.
>
> Next milestone: Logo concepts on Nov 3, 2026. Delivery is planned for Nov 27, 2026.
> Maya

Illustration with the example data. In the generator Email 5 fills in the project, milestone and dates; you write the three "..." lines.

Feedback that keeps the project moving

- **One decision-maker.** Ask early (G6) and confirm on the call.
- **Combined notes.** One document per round, not a trickle of emails.
- **A reply window.** Email 6 asks for approval or notes within 3 working days; if feedback is late, the timeline moves by the same number of days (Welcome Guide FAQ).

When something goes wrong

Tell the client first, with the new date and what you'll do about it, before they have to ask. Send it in your main channel and add the change to the next weekly update.

Out of office

Put planned time off in the Welcome Guide timeline or in the weekly update two weeks ahead, and set an auto-reply that repeats your return date.

CHAPTER 07

Handoff, Feedback & Referrals

Finish as clearly as you started.



The end of a project is when the client decides whether to hire you again, and whether to mention you to someone else. A clear handoff and an honest request for feedback do most of that work.

The handoff sheet

The Project Handoff & Feedback document lists every deliverable from your scope with a Received box, explains support after handoff, asks three feedback questions and includes a permission box for quoting the client. Send it with Email 7 and the final files.

Support after handoff

The template offers 14 days to fix anything that doesn't match the approved scope, at no extra cost; new requests are quoted at your hourly rate. Want a different period? Change "14 days" in onboarding-templates.md and in the Email 7 text before sending.

The balance invoice

Send it with the handoff, not a week later. Email 7 states the balance and your payment terms. To track who has paid and send reminders, you can use the *Freelance Client & Invoice Tracker*, a separate product; this kit works fully without it.

Asking for feedback (Email 8)

Wait one to two weeks after handoff, so the client has used the work. Email 8 asks three questions: what went well, one thing you could have done better, and how the result has helped so far. The second question gives you something to improve, and it makes the request feel like a real question rather than a hunt for praise.

Testimonials, honestly

- **Ask permission in writing.** On the handoff sheet the box is never pre-ticked; only a ticked box (or a clear "yes" by email) allows public use.
- **Quote their words.** You can shorten a quote, but don't change its meaning. If you'd like to tidy it, send the edited version back for approval.
- **Name and company only with consent.** If they'd rather stay anonymous, use their role ("Owner, coffee roaster") or don't publish.
- **Never write one for them.** No made-up quotes, no "I'll draft something you can sign". Real words, or none.

Asking for referrals

Ask once, gently, at the end of Email 8 and on the handoff sheet: "If you know someone who could use similar help, I'd be grateful for an introduction." That's enough. If they introduce someone, thank them by email the same day, and tell them how it went.

Close the file

- Remove your access to client accounts and tell the client you have.
- Mark steps 17–20 on the checklist and set the client's stage to Handed off.
- Save the signed scope, the recap and the handoff sheet in the client's folder.
- Note one thing to change in your next onboarding. Edit the template now, while you remember.

Printable Blank Forms

Form 1 of 4 · print this page, or use the generator for a typed version.

Discovery Questionnaire · General

Client _____ Project _____ Date _____

G1 What does your business do, and for whom?

G2 What is the main goal of this project?

G3 How will you know the project was a success?

G4 Who are your ideal customers or readers?

G5 Who are your main competitors or alternatives?

G6 Who gives feedback, and who has the final say?

G7 Any fixed dates, launches or events?

G8 What have you already tried, and what worked?

G9 Which files, logins or materials will you share, and by when?

G10 Anything that worries you, or that I should avoid?

Short versions of G1–G10. Full wording on page 8.

Scope & Revisions Confirmation

Client _____ Project _____ Date _____

✓ INCLUDED

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

4 _____

5 _____

6 _____

✕ NOT INCLUDED

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

4 _____

5 _____

6 _____

REVISIONS

Rounds included _____ Extra work per hour _____

A round means one set of combined notes. Changes: you ask in writing → I estimate cost and dates → you approve → I start.

PAYMENT PLAN

Deposit (%) and amount _____ Due _____

Balance _____ Due _____

SIGN-OFF

Client name _____ Freelancer name _____

Signature _____ Signature _____

Date _____ Date _____

This is a project summary, not a legal contract. It does not replace your agreement or legal advice.

Kickoff Call Agenda · 30 minutes

Client _____ Project _____ Date _____

0:00–0:03	**Welcome and introductions**	3 min
0:03–0:08	**Goals and success**	5 min
0:08–0:14	**Questionnaire follow-ups**	6 min
0:14–0:19	**Scope walk-through**	5 min
0:19–0:23	**Timeline and milestones**	4 min
0:23–0:27	**How we'll communicate**	4 min
0:27–0:30	**Next steps and owners**	3 min
	Total	**30 min**

BEFORE THE CALL

- [ ] Questionnaire back
- [ ] Scope confirmation read
- [ ] Follow-up questions listed
- [ ] Approver invited
- [ ] Link and agenda sent

AFTER THE CALL

- [ ] Recap sent within 24 h
- [ ] Scope changes in writing
- [ ] First milestone confirmed
- [ ] Folder and access set up
- [ ] Weekly update day agreed

NOTES AND DECISIONS

Project Handoff Checklist

Client _____ Project _____ Date _____

FILES DELIVERED · TICK WHEN RECEIVED

1 ☐

2 ☐

3 ☐

4 ☐

5 ☐

6 ☐

7 ☐

8 ☐

CLOSE-OUT

- ☐ Balance invoice sent
- ☐ Support period explained
- ☐ My access to accounts removed
- ☐ Feedback request date set

FEEDBACK

1 **What went well in working together?**

2 **What one thing could I have done better?**

☐ I give permission to quote my feedback publicly (with my name and company). Leave unticked and it stays private.

Received by _____ Date _____

ILLUSTRATION · EXAMPLE DATA

Worked Example

Maya Chen, a brand designer, has just signed Sam Lee of Northfield Coffee Co. for a Brand Refresh. This is the example the generator loads when you click **Load example**. All names are fictional.

Field	Maya typed
You	Maya Chen · Maya Chen Studio · Mon–Thu 9:00–17:00, ET (New York) · reply within 24 h · Email · terms 14 days
Client & project	Sam Lee · Northfield Coffee Co. · Brand Refresh · Oct 19, 2026 to Nov 27, 2026 · Design
Money	Fee 2,700 · currency $ · deposit 50% · 2 revision rounds · extra work 85 per hour
Deliverables (4)	Primary logo + 2 alternate versions · Colour palette & type system · 12-page brand guidelines (PDF) · Social profile kit (5 templates)
Not included (4)	Website design or development · Copywriting or tagline · Photography · Printing and print management
Milestones (5)	Discovery & moodboard, Oct 23 · Logo concepts, Nov 3 · Refinements (2 rounds), Nov 13 · Brand guidelines draft, Nov 20 · Final files delivered, Nov 27 (all 2026)

THE MONEY, CHECKED

`2,700 × 50% = 1,350 · balance 2,700 - 1,350 = 1,350 · 1,350 + 1,350 = 2,700`

Fee $2,700 · Deposit $1,350 · Balance $1,350

What the generator produced

Welcome Guide

"Welcome aboard, Sam." Summary strip, 5-row timeline, Email · 24 h reply, payments $1,350 / $1,350 / $2,700, next 3 steps, 6 answers.

Discovery Questionnaire

G1–G10 plus Design D1–D12: 22 questions with writing lines, returned to maya@example.com.

Scope & Revisions Confirmation

4 included, 4 not included, 2 rounds, $85/hour, 4-step change process, payment plan, signatures, disclaimer.

Kickoff Call Agenda

7 segments, 30 minutes; before/after checklists; first milestone "Discovery & moodboard, Oct 23, 2026".

Project Handoff & Feedback
The 4 deliverables with Received boxes, 14-day support, balance $1,350 within 14 days, 3 questions, unticked permission box.

Checklist (xlsx example)
Northfield Coffee: 14 Done, 1 N/A, 5 Not yet → 14 ÷ (20 − 1) = 74%. Harbor Street Dental: 7 ÷ (20 − 2) = 39%.

The 8 emails, as Maya's subjects

1	Welcome! Next steps for Brand Refresh
2	Quick reminder: your questionnaire for Brand Refresh
3	Let's book our 30-minute kickoff call for Brand Refresh
4	Recap: Brand Refresh kickoff and next steps
5	Brand Refresh: weekly update
6	Ready for your review: Discovery & moodboard (Brand Refresh)
7	Your final files for Brand Refresh
8	3 quick questions about Brand Refresh

Maya's week one

When	What Maya did
Signing day	Saved 3 PDFs, sent Email 1 with them attached, sent the deposit invoice.
2 days later	Questionnaire not back yet: sent Email 2.
Answers + signed scope in	Marked follow-ups on G6 and D7, sent Email 3 with the agenda.
Kickoff day	30-minute call; Email 4 recap the same afternoon.
Every week after	Email 5 on the same day; Email 6 for each milestone.

YOUR TURN
Click Reset in the generator, type your own details once, Save, and run your next client through the same seven steps.